



Life Time Achievement Award - R.K. Laxman

Wit, satire, irony, comedy, buffoonery, imagery, observation, interpretation. If there is one man, one genius, who has been failed by the best Thesaurus in the world, it is R K Laxman. No amount of superlatives can do justice to what has now been the staple of millions of Indians, every morning for the last 60 years. You Said It. The pocket cartoon which immortalized the man with a dhoti and a black chequered coat. A man, who has never opened his mouth since India got Independence. A man, who has watched everything and silently taken it all in his stride, the common man. R K Laxman's common man. From Nehru's speeches, to Indira's cult status, from Emergency to the days of Jan Sangh. And from Raj Narain's political antics to Rajiv Gandhi's attempts at speaking Hindi, R K Laxman's cartoons have been as incisive and emphatic as the swish in the 'x' in his signature below them. Simply put, he is best political and social commentator India ever produced. He is the one man who ensured every urban Indian woke up with a huge smile, every single morning for the past 60 years. For being the only person in India who gave the common man a character and an

identity, CNN-IBN is proud and honoured to present the Lifetime Achievement Award to R K Laxman.

"I thank the organizers for choosing me as the recipient of this prestigious award... Mrs. Kamala Laxman on his behalf - I would like to thank CNN-IBN for recognizing what he has done for the last 60 years and for giving this valuable award..."



CNN-IBN Indian of the Year-2007 - E. Sreedharan

For showing the country how a strong work ethic and quiet discipline ensures unprecedented success and timely implementation of large projects. In the process, he has changed the face of mass urban transportation, not just in the national capital, but also offered a model for the rest of the country to emulate, and for millions of commuters to benefit from. From the Konkan Railway to the metro project, he has spent a lifetime making the seemingly impossible come true.

"In all these we had put together 2-3 values as our pillars for organizational values; the integrity of individuals; professional competence and that time is money..."

CATEGORY WINNERS



P. Chidambaram - Politics

For being an astute economic manager despite coalition pressures and ensuring our growth story continued to be on a positive track throughout the year, making India one of the most sought after economies of the world.

"Politics is about bringing everything together so we can make our country a great country.

Great in sports, great in business, great in

knowledge, great in invention, great in fostering peace and harmony. All this can be brought together only by politics. And therefore I am quite proud to be in politics and proud to call myself a politician. I'm also happy that someone as unsparing and scathing like Network18 recognizes politicians as a category deserved to be awarded occasionally..."



O. P. Bhatt - Business

For showing, how despite constraints of being a public sector undertaking, an organisation can be successfully put on the global map, show improvement in results and consequently flex enough muscle in the ferociously competitive banking sector.

"I feel truly honoured especially for a public sector person this recognition has come for the first time... I am humble and this award puts on me a great duty as for the rest of my life I have to live as the CNN-IBN Indian of the Year. And after winning this award we owe it to the award to strive and to rise; to come within the top 10 banks of the world..."